

How Anti-Virus



5 Common ways viruses enter your system

- 1 You open unsafe attachments in e-mail messages
- 2 You keep the preview pane open in your e-mail client
- 3 You open a Web page that contains malicious code
- 4 Someone sends you a virus-infected file over a P2P network
- 5 You run an infected file from removable media such as a floppy disk or CD

The anti-virus software, let's call him **Buster**, constantly monitors your system. When Buster detects an infected file, or when it sees suspicious activity, it uses three approaches to identify the virus

Buster checks which virus is affecting the concerned file in one of three methods:



The Signature approach

Just like the police trace patterns in crimes back to a criminal, software engineers can reverse engineer a virus to find the signature it leaves. This signature is added to the database, so, when Buster performs a virus scan, each file is scanned for matches with any virus' signature

5 ways an anti-virus software removes infected files



Removal of virus code

Removing the viral code from the file, if possible. This is the best case scenario, no harm is done to the system

Quarantine of the infected file

Buster tries to make the file inaccessible to programs, without deleting it



Deleting the infected file

Buster deletes the file if the code cannot be removed, or the file quarantined